

Faris Syed

AUTOMOTIVE & MECHANICAL ENGINEER · EV · ENERGY · AUTONOMOUS SYSTEMS

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MSc Automotive Engineering with Business Management graduate (University of Bath, Merit) and BEng (Hons) from Heriot-Watt University (2:1), both on scholarship. Combines hands-on engineering across electric vehicle powertrains, battery and energy storage systems, and autonomous-vehicle perception with commercial capability in market analysis, go-to-market strategy, and end-to-end project delivery. IEEE-published researcher who moves comfortably between technical depth and business decision-making, with experience spanning R&D, motorsport, OEM diagnostics, and high-volume operations. UAE-based on a Golden Visa valid until 2033.

EXPERIENCE

Project Manager / Business Consultant

Jun 2025 – Sep 2025

AVL Powertrain UK / University of Bath

Bath, United Kingdom

- Led a graduate consulting engagement assessing the techno-economic feasibility of modular second-life LFP battery energy storage (BESS), owning the project charter, work breakdown, and Gantt with SMART milestones and risk logs.
- Built the UK market and technical case: chemistry selection (LFP vs NMC), grid interconnection and regulatory mapping (G99/G100, UN38.3/UKCA), competitor benchmarking, and 2030/2045 battery-return scenarios.
- Developed a 3-phase go-to-market roadmap defining Consulting, EPC, and O&M roles, and produced a VRIO and risk register underpinning an asset-light entry strategy.
- Delivered a 20-minute board-style presentation and business report to the sponsor, receiving strong feedback.

Workshop Coordinator

Nov 2025 – Mar 2026

Alba Cars

Dubai, UAE

- Led daily refurbishment and service operations across partner workshops, supervising coordinators and managing 10 to 18 vehicles per day using Kissflow and Monday.com.
- Directed readiness workflows for approximately 1,000 vehicles in 4 months while managing 150+ concurrently, coordinating inspection, logistics, procurement, and after-sales teams.
- Managed vendor selection, quotations, and workshop relationships for cost and quality control, and implemented KPI tracking to reduce delays.

Engineering Consultant

Sep 2023 – Apr 2024

Fuse.AE / Heriot-Watt University

Dubai, UAE

- Led a multidisciplinary team to design and validate an immersion-cooled battery pack for a Bajaj Pulsar EV conversion, holding cell temperatures at 44 to 48 degrees Celsius under Gulf conditions, validated in ANSYS and COMSOL.
- Identified critical failure modes through DFMEA and simplified assembly with DFMA, then developed a BOM, production schedule, and commercial viability plan for an untapped delivery-bike EV-swapping market.

Research Technician

Oct 2025

Heriot-Watt University

Dubai, UAE

- Contributed to R&D on a liquid-cooled photovoltaic system for high-temperature environments, building and installing a double-glass panel with an internal water layer and submerged heat-sink fins, and supporting rooftop field testing.

Vehicle Diagnostics & Maintenance Intern

Jun 2023 – Aug 2023

Mercedes-Benz Gargash Enterprises

Dubai, UAE

- Executed advanced diagnostics and repairs (engine head replacements, engine removals, driveshafts) using Xentry tools on premium models, and supported warranty review, workflow coordination, and service documentation.

Motorsport Engineering Intern

CWS Engineering

Jan 2024

Dubai, UAE

- Performed precise tyre changes, setups, and component adjustments trackside, contributing to 1st and 2nd in class at the 24-hour race at Dubai Autodrome.

Race / Data Engineer Intern

HRT Performance

Jan 2022

Dubai, UAE

- Supported two head engineers with telemetry collection and live data analysis across four cars at the 24h of Dubai, analysing fuel, pace, and competitor data to inform race strategy.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Autonomous Vehicle Object Detection (YOLOv5) for UAE Conditions

2023 – 2024

- Engineered and benchmarked a real-time YOLOv5 detection system on a custom UAE dataset, validated in CARLA and on a Quanser QCar across variable lighting and weather. Published in IEEE Xplore.

Plug-in Hybrid Feasibility Study, Mazda CX-5 (P0+P4)

2025

- Modelled a P0+P4 hybrid powertrain in AVL CRUISE M, achieving 76.5 km electric range, 1.99 L/100 km, and a 34% CO2 reduction over 124,000 km, with a full life-cycle assessment showing 60% environmental improvement.

Strategic Analysis: Tesla UNBX Platform & Market Repositioning

2025

- Analysed Tesla's unboxed-manufacturing shift and competitive positioning against BYD, Volkswagen, and Stellantis using Porter's Five Forces and pricing benchmarks, with recommendations on brand and pricing strategy.

Universal EV Conversion Kit for Classic Vehicles

2022 – 2023

- Led the electrical team designing core EV components and a custom subframe to mount a Tesla Model 3 drive unit into a 1969 Mustang, enabling modular retrofit while preserving original aesthetics.

EDUCATION

MSc Automotive Engineering with Business Management, Merit

University of Bath

Sep 2024 – Sep 2025

Bath, United Kingdom

BEng (Hons) Automotive Engineering, 2:1

Heriot-Watt University

Sep 2021 – Jul 2024

Dubai, UAE

TECHNICAL & PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

SIMULATION & CAE AVL CRUISE M · MATLAB/Simulink · ANSYS · Abaqus · COMSOL · CARLA · Autodesk Inventor

ENGINEERING METHODS DFMA · DFMEA/FMEA · BOM · MPS · MRP · Work Breakdown Structures · Testing & validation planning

PROGRAMMING & AI Python · YOLO · Machine learning · Deep learning · TensorFlow · PyTorch

STRATEGY & COMMERCIAL Go-to-market strategy · Market & competitive analysis (PESTLE, Porter's Five Forces, VRIO) · Financial modelling · Commercial viability planning

PROJECT & OPERATIONS Scope definition · Stakeholder engagement · Risk assessment · Change management · QA · Vendor management · Kissflow · Monday.com · Power BI

LANGUAGES English (fluent) · Hindi/Urdu (fluent)

PUBLICATION

F. Syed, M. Al Musleh, N. Abdulaziz, "Advancing Autonomous Vehicle Perception: YOLO Algorithms and Custom Dataset Integration for the UAE Environment," IEEE Xplore, 2025. DOI: 10.1109/ICRAE64368.2024.10851660